CheckIn – Daily Report

Oct 14, 2026 · @Dechen

Summary

Yesterday I finished the attendance flow end to end and pushed it for review on `feature/attendance-improvements` (4 commits). The evidence-document changes from the day before went up on `feature/evidence-management-review`.

- **Start Attendance** now runs a 2-minute window, survives leaving the page, and lets the teacher decide flagged students on the spot.
- **Check-in rules:** a student clearly outside the classroom is refused, and anyone flagged but not decided in time becomes Absent.
- **Attendance Records** were rebuilt around class sessions, with date and student search.
- **Student and management pages** got a fixed chart, cleaner tables, a green/red calendar and a full history view.
- **Evidence documents** are one request per day, visible to all the student's tutors, approved by management only.

Evidence documents

A student now sends **one** leave request for a day, without picking a module. Every tutor who teaches one of that student's modules can view it, and only management can decide.

- **Student form:** the Module field is gone, the date starts as today (no future dates), and a reason is required.
- **Who sees it:** a tutor sees a request if the student is enrolled in any module they teach. Each tutor gets one notification.
- **Who decides:** management only, enforced in both the route (`requireRole('management')`) and the service. Tutors and admin can only view.
- **Approving** marks the student Present in every enrolled module's classes that day.
- **Student page:** an Updates box shows management's decision, and each request shows "Approved by … · date".

No database change was needed. The request still stores one module because the column is required, but visibility is based on all the student's enrolments.

Start Attendance and check-in rules

The check-in window is now **2 minutes**, and every student ends up Present or Absent by the time it closes.

- **Session survives leaving the page:** coming back to Start Attendance restores the running code, timer and counts from the backend (`/sessions/mine?status=ongoing`).

- **Date** is shown on the form and on the live code panel.
- **Flagged is clickable:** the teacher opens the list, sees each flagged student and the reason, and taps **Present** or **Absent**. The Absent counter was removed from the live panel.
- **When the timer hits 0** the page ends the session at once, so undecided flagged students become Absent straight away.

Situation	Result
Inside the radius, good GPS	Present
Right code but clearly outside the radius	Refused: "You are not in the classroom area". Absent if not fixed before time ends
Weak GPS that could still be inside, location denied or failed	Flagged, and the student is told to tell the teacher
Flagged and the teacher didn't decide in time	Absent
Never checked in	Absent

Backend changes: `checkin.service.js` refuses clearly-outside check-ins and has the new flagged message; `finalizeSession` in `session.service.js` turns undecided flagged check-ins into Absent.

Attendance Records

The teacher's records are now organised by **class session** instead of only by student, and the tables use the full page width.

- **Module page:** one row per class with date, type, total hours, total present, total absent and attendance %, plus a **date search** and CSV download. A running session is marked **Live**.
- **Session page (View):** every enrolled student with ID, name, Present/Absent for that class, and their **total attendance %** in the module, which updates after every class. There's a **student ID / name search** and CSV download.
- **Flagged students** on the session page get Present / Absent buttons too.

The old tables were tiny because `base.css` sets every `.card` to 230px wide. The new page uses its own `rec-` class names. No backend change was needed; it uses the existing session roster and records routes.

Student and management pages

Students only ever see two states, green for present and red for absent. "Flagged" is a teacher-only idea.

- **Student dashboard chart:** module names now sit in their own row inside the box instead of on the axis line, with the % above each bar and bars under 90% in red. New `sdc-` class names stop clashes with other pages.
- **View attendance:** Theory and Practical each get their own box, title and total % on top, table below, and both always show ("No practical classes recorded yet" when empty).

- **Student calendar:** present days are green boxes, absent days red. A flagged day shows red until the teacher accepts it.
- **Student check-in:** sends GPS accuracy, still checks in if location fails (so the teacher can decide), uppercases the code, and blocks double clicks.
- **Management History:** each student's page now shows name, ID, total classes, present, absent and %, opens the calendar on the latest month with records, and lists every class with a CSV download.

Setup, login fix and Git

Most of the morning went into getting the restructured backend (now split into `src/routes`, `controllers`, `services`) running locally.

- **Pulled the new backend** from `dev` and ran `npm install` and `npm run generate`.
- **`.env` updates:** real `DATABASE_URL`/`DIRECT_URL` (the pull had left template values), a real `JWT_SECRET`, `PORT=5000`, `FRONTEND_URL=http://localhost:5173` (fixes "Failed to fetch"), `JWT_EXPIRES_IN=8h` and `CHECKIN_WINDOW_MINUTES=2`.
- **Login fix in `api.js`:** the backend now logs in with an httpOnly cookie, but the frontend never sent it, so every page returned 401 "Please log in". Added `credentials: 'include'`, and the Bearer header is only sent when there's a token.
- **Git:** local `dev` had diverged from GitHub and caused merge conflicts, so I backed up my commits to `backup/my-dev` and reset `dev` to match `origin/dev`.
- **Pushed:** `feature/evidence-management-review` (evidence + `api.js` fix) and `feature/attendance-improvements` (4 commits). Both need PRs into `dev`.

Next steps and notes for the team

- ☐ Open and merge the PRs for `feature/evidence-management-review` and `feature/attendance-improvements` into `dev`
- ☐ Everyone: add `FRONTEND_URL`, `JWT_EXPIRES_IN=8h`, `CHECKIN_WINDOW_MINUTES=2` and the shared `JWT_SECRET` to `backend/.env`
- ☐ Check the Records styles are in `records.css` (they may have gone into `reports.css`)
- ☐ Clear the 4 duplicate test evidence requests from the old version (management reject, or team lead deletes)
- ☐ Test the flagged flow on real phones in a classroom
- ☐ Optional: let the teacher pick a past date on Start Attendance (needs a small backend change)

For the team lead: `requireAuth` swallows database errors and returns "Please log in", so a database outage looks like a login problem. Worth returning a clearer "server unavailable" error.